Supported shoulder-blade control

Scapular control / 6-10 easy repetitions



START / relaxed shoulders FINISH / gentle blade control

MAIN: Middle trapezius and rhomboids gently retract the shoulder blades.

SECONDARY: Posterior shoulder and rotator-cuff muscles help steady the arms while the shoulder blades move. Use a gentle movement, not a maximal squeeze.

BASE / SUPPORT: Chair, feet and light trunk control maintain an upright seated position.

01 / Check the setup

Sit in a stable chair without a band. Rest hands comfortably on thighs.

02 / Set the base and brace

Keep neck long, ribs settled and shoulders relaxed. Avoid starting in an exaggerated chest-out posture.

03 / Move with control

Gently guide the shoulder blades slightly toward one another, then release. Breathe throughout.

04 / Limit the range and return

Use a small comfortable movement; stop before shrugging, arching or pressing shoulders forcefully down.

WATCH FOR: Do not pinch hard, pull the head backward or add load to compensate for poor control.
EASIER: Use a smaller motion or just practice relaxed posture and breathing.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: AAOS - Shoulder Conditioning Program; AAOS - Spine Conditioning Program. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html